Moreover, having interacted with numerous patriots in the states I walked in (something my co-editor assures me was mirrored in the remaining six states), people are desperate to do something. They are no longer satisfied with being conscientious bystanders. Mirroring India's civilizational history, multiple ideas, ideologies and energies are once again itching to flow together as one united force. The silent majority feels suffocated at the perversions inflicted upon this ancient civilization's ethos —at the lies, hatred and violence drowning out the best in us. We feel our destinies are not of our own choosing, and are chagrined at the assault on our way of life. We all yearn for the renewal of a time when honour, integrity and truth counted for something; when we looked forward instead of backwards, and when our successes were not contingent on the misfortunes of our fellow Indians. What began as a murmur is now raring to become a roar. This impulse cannot be left to the devices of history—it needs to be constructively channelized and institutionalized. This confers a special responsibility on all of us, for history calls on us to rise to the occasion.

Therefore, instead of looking at the Congress party as a movement (as it originally was), perhaps it's time to reimagine the Congress into a nerve centre that enables and coordinates a million flowers across India. In this reading, progressive forces can be actively empowered to programmatically re-engineer both India's software (culture, values and attitudes) and hardware (economy, institutions and systems). Re-engineering India's software would mean reshaping social consciousness by disseminating liberal, plural and democratic values creatively through films/serials, books, news, social media, educational systems and religions (like the Congress movement once did during the freedom struggle). It would mean escalating the normative and ideological battle we find ourselves in beyond 'centres of resistance' such as Shaheen Bagh, Jantar Mantar, Roshan Bagh, Azad Maidan and Singhu border. This is because progressives need to especially convince those who do not subscribe to liberalism and secularism. This necessitates rebuilding relationships with the people and moving from the streets into homes. On the other hand, re-engineering India's hardware